

1 GAME OVERVIEW

Lead a traveling circus across the northeastern United States. Hire artists, arrange each ring, and perform in towns and cities to gain Fame.

- Players: 1-4 | Play time: about 75 minutes
- Tableau building, route planning, and regional majority.
- Win with the most Fame after final scoring.

2 SETUP CHRONOLOGY

- A
- Choose active regions: 2P uses New York, Washington D.C., plus Boston or Indianapolis; 3P closes Boston or Chicago; 4P uses all five.
- B
- Cover closed regions and remove matching regional End Game cards.
- C
- Score markers at 0. Shuffle all decks; reveal 5 Ticket cards.
- D
- Randomize City tokens; place a City card at each active main city.
- E
- Barnum starts in Boston, or New York if Boston is closed.
- F
- Take player board and pieces; pedestal marker starts at 1.
- G
- Deal 1 End Game card, 1 Ticket, and 4 Money cards.
- H
- Choose start player. Player to the right takes the Barnum tile.

3 STRUCTURE OF A TURN

FIRST TURN

Place caravan in an unoccupied main city, then Engage 1 Artist.

CHOOSE 1 ACTION

Engage an Artist OR Perform a Show.

ENGAGE

Insert 1 card in strict increasing order. Pay full value or the difference from the row maximum.

PERFORM: MOVE

Move at least 1 step up to visible Movement. Skip occupied small towns.

PERFORM: SHOW

Resolve a small town, medium city, or main city. Perform once per location.

MOVE BARNUM

After every performance, move Barnum 1 step counterclockwise unless prevented.

END TURN

Discard to 10 cards, refill Ticket display, then next player.

4 TABLE SETUP



Use this visual with setup callouts A-H.
2P: add 6 neutral tents as listed in the rulebook.

1 KEY MECHANICS / RULES REFRESHER

- Rows remain strictly increasing; no duplicate value in a row.
- First card costs full value; later cards cost the positive difference from the row maximum. No change.
- Placement bonuses trigger the first time covered. Complete early columns to place End Game cards.
- Small town: gain 1 Money plus adjacent empty towns and visible Money icons.
- Medium city: use pedestal total and one preferred-performer +2 bonus.
- Main city: required artist; score 6 base, +4 preceding support, +5 following support, plus timing bonus.
- Play at most 1 Instant Effect card per performance.
- After each performance move Barnum; score a region when Barnum stops in its main city.

2 SCORING SUMMARY

- Small town: Money only.
- Medium city: Ticket cards or Fame shown by the claimed slot.
- Main city: 6 base +4 left support +5 right support +3 first / +1 second.
- Region majority: 10 / 6 / 3 Fame.
- End game: Ticket effects plus placed End Game Scoring cards.

3 STRATEGIC TIPS

GOOD HABITS

- Build rows for main-city requirements and supports.
- Use rich small towns early.
- Track pedestal breakpoints.
- Complete columns early enough to place scoring cards.

COMMON MISTAKES

- A performance requires movement.
- Refill Ticket display only at turn end.
- Remember visible Money icons and the hand limit.
- Move Barnum after every performance.

COMPETITIVE TIPS

- Contest regions before Barnum scores them.
- Earlier main-city slots improve points and tie strength.
- Use low-cost insertions to reshape row effects.

4 END OF GAME

- Trigger: Barnum completes a full loop and scores the starting region.
- Add end-game Fame on Ticket and placed End Game cards.
- Most Fame wins.
- Tie: majority in the last scored region, then earlier regions in reverse order.